

People are never a means to an end

Customers and team members are not tools for getting what you want. Treat each one as a person whose own goals matter.

REMEMBER

- ◆ When a client becomes a number, the relationship has already started to end.
- ◆ Ask what this person wants, not only what you want from them.
- ◆ Trust is built when people can tell you are not using them.

YOUR TURN

Where I have been thinking of people as numbers (leads, seats, sales, reviews):

A client I have treated mostly as a way to reach my goal:

What that client wants for themselves:

A practice I would change if I saw every customer as an end in themselves:

The same question for someone on my team:

THIS WEEK

Before your next sales conversation, write down what the other person is hoping for. Start the conversation there.

Inspired by Michael Schur, "How Ethics Can Help You Make Better Decisions" (TED).